

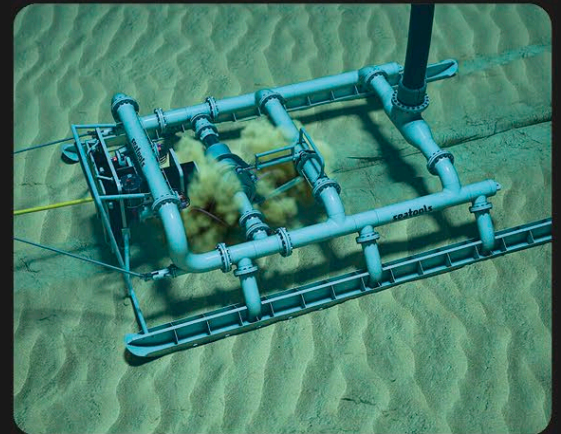


The fastest
fiber-optic
cables can carry
30 million
phone calls
at once.



2 Off to sea

The ship travels to the right location, where the cable is connected to a point on land. The ship then starts to move, rolling out the cable behind it as it goes.



3 Settling into the seabed

Once on the seabed, the cable is fed out through a plow. As the plow is dragged after the ship and carves out a trench in the seabed, the cable is safely buried.



4 Maintaining the cable

Despite many measures to protect undersea cables, they can be damaged. Mending them requires divers or small submarines to investigate, then bring the affected section to the surface for repair.